



Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

Guidance

Safety Bulletin 2 - Dangerously weighted ships heaving lines

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Summary of issue

There have been several instances where dangerously weighted heaving lines, including the use of monkey's fists with additional weights inserted into them, have been used resulting in serious injury.

Further guidance is contained in Ch 26 section 26.3.5 in the Code of Safe Working Practices for Merchant Seafarers

(<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/code-of-safe-working-practices-for-merchant-seafarers-2020>).

Vessels using dangerously weighted heaving lines in the UK may be subject to prosecution.

Examples

Examples of dangerously weighted heaving lines



Dangerously weighted heaving line.



Further example of dangerously weighted heaving line.



Dangerously weighted 'Monkey fist' that had additional weights inserted.

Examples of safe alternatives



High-visibility soft pouch.



‘Monkey fist’ made of rope only, no additional weights added.



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